

College of Engineering teach Python either as part of the official curriculum or as a supplementary skill. Many students from India participate in Google Summer of Code (GSoC) projects related to Python and this number is growing.

Senthil Kumaran, one of the Python core developers from India who entered the project via GSoC talks about his experience – “Being a part of an Open Source project, especially a widely used one like Python has been an amazing experience. It has taught me many things, most important of which is we work not for competition, money or fame, but for enjoyment. It also takes away a good amount of time from you and you are never short of anything to do. Serious software engineering as a hobby and software as a craft is something many of us from India are yet to come to grasp with, this is teaching me exactly that.”

Another prominent example of the role of Python in education is the FOSSEE project sponsored by the Ministry of Human Resources and Development. It aims to bring programming skills to scientific professionals to do their work and the language of choice is Python.

The Indian Python community

There are active user groups in Pune, Bangalore, Chennai, the NCR region and many other large Indian cities. The Bangalore group, which is one of the oldest, was created in 2007 or so and has met semi regularly since then at various times. Anand Pillai, who was instrumental in starting the initial Bangalore Python user group or “Bangpypers” as it is called, is still an active member of the community. The community grew over the years and in 2009, the first PyCon in India was held at the Indian Institute of Science in Bangalore.

The Python Software Foundation

The Python Software Foundation is a non-profit organisation established in the United States for advancing open source technology related to the Python language. One of its activities is the organisation of a worldwide conference for all Python developers called “PyCon”. Regional conferences have sprouted around the world catering to local needs and in 2009, the first one was held in India. This was conducted in consultation with the PSF and while small, kick started PyCon India.

The conference has grown since then. 2010 saw the event again in Bangalore at MSRT and in 2011, it was conducted in Pune. In 2012, it moved back to Bangalore and was conducted at Dharmaram college. Over the years, the conference grew and keynote speakers who were part of the core Python developer group were invited from abroad. Tutorials were added to the main

*pointers

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<http://dvwx.in/TPvoeu>

conference and the number of delegates as well as sponsors grew over the years. It is a volunteer driven event that the Indian Python community looks forward to every year.

The Python Software Society of India

To facilitate PyCon India and to spearhead work that takes Python and related technologies forward in India, the Python Software Society of India was formed shortly after the 2009 conference. It is a non-profit organisation that oversees the conference and takes care of finances and book keeping not much unlike the PSF worldwide. It has recently instituted an award for students active in the Python community in honour of the first President of the society, Kenneth Gonсалves, who passed away earlier this year.

Join the Indian Python community

While there is no real formal “community” as such, participating in the user group meetings and helping out with PyCon India are a great way to get to know the larger Python community. It can be a rewarding technical and social experience. We'd love to have you! The official PyCon India mailing list is at <http://mail.python.org/mailman/listinfo/inpycon>. Signing up will let you take part in the discussions leading to the conference. Calls for volunteers and other such things are made on the list. Local user groups have their own mailing lists where meetups are organised. Joining the one in the city closest to you is a good way to meet local Pythonistas. If your city doesn't have one, considering starting one yourself.

- ChennaiPy (Chennai): <https://groups.google.com/forum/?fromgroups#!forum/chennaipy>
- Bangpypers (Bangalore): <http://mail.python.org/mailman/listinfo/bangpypers>
- PythonPune (Pune): <https://groups.google.com/forum/?fromgroups#!forum/PythonPune>
- NCR-Python.in (NCR): <http://mail.python.org/mailman/listinfo/ncr-python.in>

The community section of the official website of the Python programming language is at <http://python.org/community/> and you might find links there that are relevant as well. >

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